

MOMENT TO SAVOUR Players lift Team India head coach Rahul Dravid after the win against South Africa in the T20 World Cup final. It was Dravid's last match as India coach

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The core of the idea was that the batting unit as a whole needed to be greater than the sum of its parts. A team of eight batters needed to keep the foot on the pedal at all times to utilise all its resources in the batting phase. This would allow the team to set par-plus totals on every occasion rather than settle for just par totals, as was usual during the earlier, more conservative approach.

The India vs Bangladesh match during the Super-8 stage served up a great example. India amassed a very healthy 196 on a pitch where 180 looked par. Revealingly, the score was reached with only one half-centurion in their ranks; the rest of the batters chipped in with quick-fire 20s and 30s. Captain Rohit Sharma would later term it a 'perfect' match, giving us a clear insight into the change in the Indian approach.

This very template allowed India to notch a match-winning 171 on a tricky pitch in Guyana against England in the semi-final. Where most other teams would have aimed for a safe 150, the Men in Blue held fast to their new credo and put the defending champions on the back foot in the first half itself. This innate change in Team India did not escape the opposition. Asked about the difference between the current Indian team and the one brushed aside by England in the 2022 T20 World Cup semis, Matthew Mott, the England coach, replied, "They weren't sure what a good score [was], back in 2022.

THE INDIAN TEAM HIT THE RIGHT NOTES AND EMERGED CHAMPIONS, BUT COACH RAHUL DRAVID WAS AS SELF-EFFACING AS EVER. THE WIN IN THE CARIBBEAN WAS REDEMPTIVE FOR HIM TOO

Their approach now is to come hard at us, maximise their batting and score out of our reach."

Looking at it from a macro level, India's batting philosophy during the ICC T20 World Cup 2024 can best be summed up thus—runs in front of an individual's name don't matter, it's the total runs that count. In an interview to INDIA TODAY after the win, Suryakumar Yadav confirmed this by saying, "I have to put my game, my ego behind and put the team ahead. In games against the US, England, Australia, I needed to take a step back and bat according to what the team needs. When we need to bat with the tempo, I press the accelerator hard."